

r/aiwars

People using ai are not wasting power, please put this foolish talking point to rest

Posted by u/SolidCake • • 0 points • 60 comments

This isnt another thread meant to point out that training AI and using it are a drop in the bucket for overall energy expenditure. theres plenty of threads on that

when you're criticizing someone's use of AI because it "wastes power", you are spreading corporate propaganda. The very concept of an individuals "carbon footprint" is a lie, its american individualism to the toxic extreme. Climate change is, largely, almost entirely the fault of a handful of giant corporations. (<https://amp.theguardian.com/sustainable-business/2017/jul/10/100-fossil-fuel-companies-investors-responsible-71-global-emissions-cdp-study-climate-change>)

Obviously, we should all live more sustainable lives. I will criticize having a large truck if you don't need it. Or having a green monoculture lawn that you spread chemicals on. But one person using AI is so insignificant you may as well be going after them for playing videogames too! Or leaving their (LED) lights on when they leave the room

<https://amp.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2021/aug/23/big-oil-coined-carbon-footprints-to-blame-us-for-their-greed-keep-them-on-the-hook>

<https://www.nytimes.com/2021/08/31/opinion/climate-change-carbon-neutral.html>

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-06 14:03 UTC

[removed]

u/MetatypeA • 0 points • 2024-10-11 20:38 UTC

Bro. BRO.

60% of all Carbon Output comes from China. They are industrially where we were 140 years ago. They don't have safety regulations. They don't have smog regulations.

In the US, the primary source of fuel has been burning coal. We're leveling mountains of the stuff to mine it and burn it.

Do you know how much electricity it takes to move data en masse? It's a crapton.

Does it waste power? No. Does it use power outsourced as carbon emissions? It absolutely does. It does vary, depending on which state you live, but it absolutely does.

Not as much as streaming though. Streaming is huge carbon output.

u/HauntingAd5380 • 1 points • 2024-10-11 12:14 UTC

I'm about as pro ai as you get but people like you OP are exactly why the antis will keep having ammunition against it